← 05 · Check the files | Step 5 of 15 — Two boots | 06 · Make the three keys →

Two boots

Time	Difficulty	Steps	You will need
45 min	Careful	4 sections	Everyday computer, Tails USB

Boot 1 · Network on

Watches balances. Builds a payment. Never holds a seed.

- Verify files
- Watch-only wallet
- Export unsigned file

then

shut down

Boot 2 · Networking off

This stick is the offline computer. It borrows the hardware, then forgets.

Networking off

- One seed in memory
- Sign the file
- Full shutdown after

One computer, used twice. The first boot watches the wallet and broadcasts finished payments — it never holds a seed. The second boot is the Tails USB: networking off, exactly one seed, then a full shutdown. The seed lives in memory only. Shutdown wipes it.

What "airgapped" means here

Yes:

- Networking Disabled on the Tails welcome screen, before the desktop.
- Files cross on the data USB — payment files, the map, checked programs.
- The online computer stays watch-only.

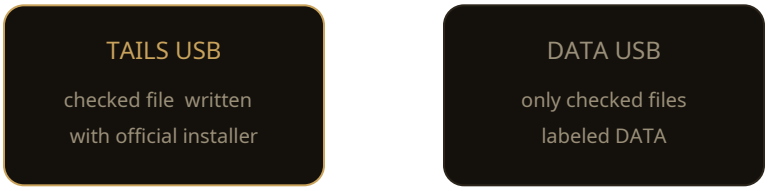
Not airgapped:

- Turning networking off after Sparrow opened.

scan for the full sheet

- Unplugging a disk that was online yesterday.
- A photo of a seed. A password manager, printer, or cloud note as backup.

Prepare the two USBs



NO PERSISTENT STORAGE — THE DRIVE STAYS AMNESIC

Download Tails only from the official site. Check the signature and checksum before writing. Write it with the official installer, label it TAILS. Do not create Persistent Storage — skip the passphrase. The data USB gets only files that already passed the checks.

Every offline session

1. Boot the Tails drive. Networking Disabled. Don't unlock Persistent Storage.
2. Copy only the file that session needs from the data USB.
3. Do the work: convert dice, restore one seed, sign one file, or export the map.
4. Copy the result back to the data USB. Shut down fully — dark screen before the drive comes out.

STOP

Stop if

Stronger (optional): a dedicated old laptop with the Wi-Fi card physically pulled. Ethernet never plugged. The Tails file is still checked, networking still Disabled, data USB still clean — the stick remains the only wire.

Next. The three keys are made next. A word is not written until Tails is running with networking turned off.